

***Data structures* define how you store data in a programming language. Every programming language has a core set of data structures. *Data types* refer to the data structures you're using or the kind of information stored in those data structures.**

Much of programming focuses on handling data. How you represent data through code impacts what you can do with that data: if you model your data well, your program is easier to work with.

Choosing a specific approach to data modeling informs how you think about data, so knowing the available data structures in a programming language will help you best represent the information in your project.

The most common data structures include variables, sequences, mappings, classes, and objects. Python also has text-based data types, such as strings, and numerical data types, such as integers and floats.